RHONDA TIDGWELL –ENCOURAGING A COMMUNITY OF RECREATIONAL READING

My goal is to create partnerships amongst the whole-school community in order to foster a love of reading, and encourage recreational reading year round! In developing a recreational reading plan, I have included a variety of motivators in my long-range Learning Commons plan, which align closely with the theory of Learning Partnerships:

"Members of a school community collaborate to build virtual and physical learning partnerships in the Learning Commons. These partnerships are global, connected, social, crosscurricular and complex." (Together for Learning, OLSA, 2010).

- Nurture good reading habits through teaching students how to choose books, and by leading students to books that may be appealing to them.

- Allow for student voice, provide choice, and represent the students in the books they read –Open up the LC for student-led events and presentations, welcome student-feedback, leave room for exploration, maintain a rich and interesting collection to meet needs, and where students see themselves in the books.

- Gamify! – Use incentives, create leaderboards, host celebrations, have in-book treasure hunts, hold contests, and play digital games, such as Kahoot.

- Promote using readers' choice –Use social media and a digital magazine, keep displays current, attractive, and relevant to peak community interest.

- Include social reads –Host high-interest book-clubs and book-talks, both physical and virtual.

- Link reading with technology through tools, such as Skype, audio, video, Google Lit Trips, and Virtual Reality viewers.

- Engage through in-person and virtual author workshops and guest visits.

- Collaborate – Create a culture of collaboration throughout the school community as a whole.

- Invite, be flexible, and share the space –Create true partnerships, welcome staff to share the LC space, including hosting events or clubs.

- Host PLCs and lunch-n-learn events to share physical and virtual resources with staff, as well as offer ideas and tools to take back to their classrooms.

- Include families as partners –Welcome volunteers, host whole-school events, encourage reading at home.

- Learn from the greater community beyond the walls of the school –Partnering with public libraries to promote their resources and literacy programs, connecting with other community resources (e.g., inter-generational and buddy , connect with other readers through the Forest of Reading, Skype and other virtual tools.

- Work alongside the administration to ensure the LC reflects the goals of, and is included in, the school's SIP (School Improvement Plan).

RHONDA TIDGWELL —ENCOURAGING A COMMUNITY OF RECREATIONAL READING LONG-RANGE PLAN

	Month	Themes for displays. Mini-lessons & Read Alouds	Learning Commons Events	STEM / Maker Pop-ups	Weekly use of space during lunch hours	Ongoing	Once in a While
	September	Introduction to the LC, Virtual Library, and kid-friendly tools Totally Middle School Read-alouds Getting to School picture book read-aloud LC Scavenger Hunt	Kahoots (fun digital quiz game introducing students to the LC, the collection, and literature)	Bookmark design contest (winners to be printed in colour for whole school)	Robotics Club begins Learning Commons Crew meets Tuesdays & Thursdays MAKER Mondays TECH Tuesdays WELLNESS Wednesdays WONDER Wednesdays (wonderopolis) THINKER Thursdays (peer tutoring)	Distribute technology, set up sign-outs for carts Create class visits schedule Create Stakeholder survey DAILY— -Post on social media (Instagram) WEEKLY— Update webpage BI-WEEKLY— Class library visits on rotation MONTHLY— -Update digital magazine (#trending) MONTHLY— -Update displays and bulletin boards Partnering (ongoing) Involvement in SIP with admin.	Manage LC budget Request funds from Parent Council Check in with staff re. technology "Tastings"— Lunch n' Learns for Staff on books, resources, and technology: Let's TACO 'bout Books (taco lunch) FRY-YAY! (french-fry theme) Sweet Reads (dessert theme) Appetizing Apps (appetizer theme) Host PLCs
FALL	October	Indigenous Education Month – Orange Shirt Day International Day if the Girl + Body Confidence Awareness	SOCK-tober (home-insecurity awareness + sock drive) Family Math Night Station	Slime-making Whole school zombie attack STEM challenge			
FALL	November	Remembrance Day International Day for the Elimination of Violence Against Women	SOCK Drive continues Scholastic Book Fair (overlap with parent conferences)	Marble mazes Robotics begins			
FALL	December	Festival of Lights (Diwali, Hanukkah, Winter Solstice, Christmas…)	Festival of Lights	Penny spinners			
WINTER	January	Growth Mindsets Forest of Reading presentations Author Spotlight Holocaust Remembrance	Arrange author visits (includes digital) Grade 6 trip to public library	Lego night lights			
WINTER	February	African Heritage Month Family Day (family diversity)	Family Day / Reading as a Family (literacy stations)	Using the green-screen + prop-making			
WINTER	March	Sikh New Year / Cultural diversity	Family Culture Night	VR Viewers & VR apps			

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SPRING	April	International Day of Pink Earth Day Mystery Skype	Earth Day / Earth Hour Unplugged Grade 7 trip to public library	Voice-recordings & videos	FOREST Fridays (Virtual Author Visits – Forest of Reading) Spring— Campfire Book Talks (Forest of Reading) Robotics ends (mid-May) Collection of books and resources, re-shelving	DAILY— -Post on social media (Instagram) WEEKLY— Update webpage BI-WEEKLY— Class library visits on rotation MONTHLY— -Update digital magazine (#trending) MONTHLY— -Update displays and bulletin boards Partnering (ongoing) Involvement in SIP with admin.	Check in with staff re. technology Manage LC budget "Tastings"— Lunch n' Learns for Staff on books, resources, and technology: Let's TACO 'bout Books (taco lunch) FRY-YAY! (french-fry theme) Sweet Reads (dessert theme) Appetizing Apps (appetizer theme) Host PLCs
	May	Challenging Gender Stereotypes International Day Against Homophobia & Transphobia Asian Heritage	Eid Celebration (samosas and sweets readings) Woodland Celebration (Forest of Reading)	How strong is spaghetti? STEM Challenge			
	June	Toronto Pride National Aboriginal Day Summer Solstice	Pride Author Visits Grade 8 trip to public library	Take inventory of technology in the school			

Keep Reading!

Sources

Together For Learning, OLSA 2010

Teens in Recreational Reading
https://readcreateshare.wordpress.com/2018/05/30/engaging-teens-in-recreational-reading/